Kaira Villanueva

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SKILLS

Product Management
Jira
Confluence
Agile development
Scrum project management
User stories
Product roadmap
Competitive analysis

Product Design
Figma
Sketch
Miro
Adobe Creative Suite
Salesforce user experience
Stakeholder design sessions
Site mapping
User interviews
Wireframing
Rapid prototyping
Journey maps
HTML / CSS / SCSS / JS

Exhibit & Interactive Media
Interactive installations
Game design
Augmented reality (Artivive)
Blender
After Effects
Premiere Pro
Photoshop
Krita
Sculpture & fabrication
Mural & acrylic painting

User Research
Mixpanel
Dovetail
Tableau
Hotjar
UserTesting
Heap
Pendo
A/B testing
Qualitative interviews
Thematic coding
Usability testing

Development
React
Angular
Python
Unity / C#
Unreal Engine
iOS / Objective-C / Swift

EDUCATION

University of Pennsylvania
Executive Program for Social Innovation Design 2023

Columbia University
B.A. Human Rights
Specialization in Information Science
Class of 2021

Pursuit
iOS Mobile Design and Development Fellowship
Class of 2016

SELECTED PROJECTS

2021 - 2025
Installation & Game Designer, NYC Poetry Festival, Governors Island
- Designed, built, and installed three public, interactive poetry installations across three festivals
- Created two game-based experiences: a rune puzzle for composing poems and a role-playing fossil dig
- Sculpted moss and chicken-wire foxes, a 12-foot willow portal, and a life-size velociraptor fossil

2022 - 2023
Lead Artist, A Story of Floods, NJ Coastal Resiliency Art Program
- Co-designed and painted Atlantic City's first augmented reality mural, interpreting sea-level rise for the public
- Built the AR layer with Artivive, Unity, Blender, and After Effects for smartphone visitors
- Led a stencil and painting workshop with kids from the Chelsea Boys & Girls Club
- Co-produced, wrote, and filmed a documentary on residents' experiences of flooding
- Premiered the documentary at the Noyes Arts Garage of Stockton University, leading a panel of experts and residents
- Screened the film and led a workshop for Stockton University students and faculty, featured in The Stockton Argo

2020
Game Designer & Developer, Intro to Game UI
- Designed and built a Unity/WebGL game that teaches diegetic and non-diegetic UI through play
- Mapped player journeys through DOOM: Eternal and Left 4 Dead to study visual and sound cues

EXPERIENCE

06/2026 - Present
Research Analyst, Human Rights Research Center
- Researching and publishing articles focusing on the global technology supply chain
- Synthesizing the latest literature, reviews, and policies in relation to the topic

01/2025 - 01/2026
Product Owner, Verizon Connect
- Collaborated with cross-functional stakeholders to gather business requirements
- Authored user stories and structured epics to guide development in agile sprints
- Mapped out product processes for identifying projects to be added to the backlog
- Designed and iterated on prototypes to align solutions with stakeholders
- Refined designs with developers to simplify them prior to sprint development
- Designed end-to-end user flows to drive the goals of the product roadmap

07/2024 - 12/2024
10/2023 - 07/2024
Lead UX Designer, Verizon Connect
UX Designer II
- Assessed Salesforce support impact through evaluations, interviews, and analysis
- Designed Salesforce flows collaboratively through design workshops
- Researched pain points in Sales Cloud and Service Cloud to close business gaps
- Created a design system for Salesforce UX in support and sales
- Improved support tooling and case intake with cross-functional teams
- Collaborated with service designers to create journey maps and blueprints

12/2021 - 03/2023
UX Designer, Vestwell
- Designed internal tools for managing 401k plans and investments
- Designed client-facing experiences such as onboarding and login
- Conducted user interviews to design an investment management tool
- Contributed to designing reusable components and maintaining libraries
- Designed A/B tests via Usability Hub to check for usability

01/2020 - 01/2021
Research Assistant, Columbia University: Computational Lab
- Designed a web application focusing on user localization
- Conducted user interviews and analyzed results using thematic analysis
- Conducted competitor analysis with other products that utilize user localization
- Designed the user experience and interface based on the collected data
- Carried out A/B testing to check for the effectiveness of user localization

08/2019 - 11/2020
03/2019 - 08/2019
UX Designer, Kinetic
UX Designer Intern
- Designed the initial experience and interface for an internal asset management tool
- Conducted user interviews to check for insights helpful for iteration
- Implemented Mixpanel to collect and assess user data from the web application
- Assisted with designing weekly reports and graphics for client-facing emails
- Converted email templates into HTML/CSS and web designs into React components

11/2018 - 06/2019
Product Designer, Cyclops Research & Development, Inc
- Led the design for a mobile application that collects and assesses water data
- Audited the existing procedure for collecting and inputting data
- Designed a responsive user interface based on the user personas
- Carried out A/B testing with participants to check for interface usability
- Used Swift to convert the mobile design into an interactive iOS application

03/2018 - 11/2018
UX Engineer, ClassLink
- Assisted with building a design system framework to speed up web development
- Designed graphic badges as assets for a badge generator web application
- Designed graphic logos and icons for an onboarding experience
- Assisted with storyboarding product features to assess for usability
- Used Angular and Sass to convert web designs into interactive components

08/2016 - 09/2017
03/2016 - 08/2016
Software Engineer, Agrilyst (Acquired by IUNU)
Software Engineer Intern
- Wrote software tutorials and walkthroughs on new features
- Tested the platform for quality assurance and reported bugs
- Researched Cornell University's GAP and applied findings as a new feature
- Drafted a web tool that manages the user's food safety protocols in indoor farms
- Developed and automated web scraping scripts to gather HTML content
- Organized and cleaned large sets of data in Excel

VOLUNTEER

08/2026 - Present
Crisis Text Counselor, Crisis Text Line
- Training as a crisis text counselor for an emergency text hotline

10/2025 - Present
Creative Arts Tutor, CoachArt
- Created a 4-week Intro to World Poetry curriculum geared toward middle-school students
- Led and taught the 4-week class to a student facing serious illness

PUBLICATION

Robert Soden, Lydia B. Chilton, Scott Miles, Rebecca Bicksler, Kaira Ray Villanueva, and Melissa Bica. 2022. Insights and Opportunities for HCI Research into Hurricane Risk Communication. In CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '22). https://dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3491102.3502101